Text 1

第 1 段

In spite of “endless talk of difference,” American society is an amazing machine for homogenizing people. There is “the democratizing uniformity of dress and discourse, and the casualness and absence of deference” characteristic of popular culture. People are absorbed into “a culture of consumption” launched by the 19th-century department stores that offered “vast arrays of goods in an elegant atmosphere. Instead of intimate shops catering to a knowledgeable elite” these were stores “anyone could enter, regardless of class or background. This turned shopping into a public and democratic act.” The mass media, advertising and sports are other forces for homogenization.

直译：尽管人们“无休止地谈论差异”，美国社会仍是一台惊人的使人同质化的机器。大众文化有这样的特征：“衣着和言谈中趋于平等的一致性，以及随意、不讲尊卑的态度。”人们被吸收到一种由 19 世纪百货商店开启的“消费文化”中；这些商店“在优雅环境中提供种类繁多的商品。它们不是迎合见多识广精英的亲切小店”，而是“不论阶级或背景，任何人都能进入的商店。这使购物成为公开而平等的活动”。大众传媒、广告与体育，也是促使人们同质化的力量。

第 2 段

Immigrants are quickly fitting into this common culture, which may not be altogether elevating but is hardly poisonous. Writing for the National Immigration Forum, Gregory Rodriguez reports that today’s immigration is neither at unprecedented levels nor resistant to assimilation. In 1998 immigrants were 9.8 percent of the population; in 1900, 13.6 percent. In the 10 years prior to 1990, 3.1 immigrants arrived for every 1,000 residents; in the 10 years prior to 1890, 9.2 for every 1,000. Now, consider three indices of assimilation: language, home ownership and intermarriage.

直译：移民正迅速融入这种共同文化。这种文化也许并不完全能提升人的精神境界，但也很难说有害。格雷戈里·罗德里格斯为全国移民论坛撰文指出，今天的移民规模既没有达到前所未有的水平，也并非抗拒同化。1998 年，移民占总人口 9.8%；1900 年为 13.6%。1990 年之前的十年中，每 1000 名居民对应 3.1 名新到移民；1890 年之前的十年中，每 1000 人对应 9.2 名。现在，来看看同化的三个指标：语言、住房拥有情况和族际通婚。

第 3 段

The 1990 Census revealed that “a majority of immigrants from each of the fifteen most common countries of origin spoke English ‘well’ or ‘very well’ after ten years of residence.” The children of immigrants tend to be bilingual and proficient in English. “By the third generation, the original language is lost in the majority of immigrant families.” Hence the description of America as a “graveyard” for languages. By 1996 foreign-born immigrants who had arrived before 1970 had a home ownership rate of 75.6 percent, higher than the 69.8 percent rate among native-born Americans.

直译：1990 年人口普查显示，“来自十五个最主要来源国的移民，在每个群体中，大多数人在居住十年后，英语都说得‘好’或‘非常好’”。移民子女往往能说两种语言，并熟练掌握英语。“到第三代，大多数移民家庭已经失去原来的语言。”因此，美国被形容为语言的“墓地”。到 1996 年，在 1970 年前到达美国的外国出生移民，住房拥有率达到 75.6%，高于美国本土出生者的 69.8%。

第 4 段

Foreign-born Asians and Hispanics "have higher rates of intermarriage than do U.S.-born whites and blacks." By the third generation, one third of Hispanic women are married to non-Hispanics, and 41 percent of Asian-American women are married to non-Asians.

直译：在外国出生的亚裔和西班牙语裔人士，" 其族际通婚率高于美国出生的白人和黑人 "。到第三代，三分之一的西班牙语裔女性嫁给非西班牙语裔人士，而 41% 的亚裔美国女性嫁给非亚裔人士。

第 5 段

Rodriguez notes that children in remote villages around the world are fans of superstars like Arnold Schwarzenegger and Garth Brooks, yet "some Americans fear that immigrants living within the United States remain somehow immune to the nation's assimilative power."

直译：罗德里格斯指出，世界各地偏远村庄的孩子，都是阿诺德 · 施瓦辛格和加思 · 布鲁克斯等超级明星的粉丝；然而，" 一些美国人却担心，生活在美国境内的移民，竟不知何故仍能不受这个国家同化力量的影响 "。

第 6 段

Are there divisive issues and pockets of seething anger in America? Indeed. It is big enough to have a bit of everything. But particularly when viewed against America's turbulent past, today's social indices hardly suggest a dark and deteriorating social environment.

直译：美国存在引发分裂的问题和局部沸腾的愤怒吗？确实存在。美国足够大，什么都会有一点。但尤其是与美国动荡的过去相比，今天的社会指标几乎并不表明社会环境黑暗且正在恶化。

篇章简析

主旨：美国共同文化具有很强同化力，移民并非像某些人担忧的那样抗拒融入。作者用历史移民比例及三项同化指标支持判断；末段承认矛盾存在，但否定整体持续恶化的推断。既有数字按所附文本保留。

Text 2

第 1 段

Stratford-on-Avon, as we all know, has only one industry - William Shakespeare—but there are two distinctly separate and increasingly hostile branches. There is the Royal Shakespeare Company (RSC), which presents superb productions of the plays at the Shakespeare Memorial Theatre on the Avon. And there are the townsfolk who largely live off the tourists who come, not to see the plays, but to look at Anne Hathaway's Cottage, Shakespeare's birthplace and the other sights.

直译：众所周知，埃文河畔斯特拉特福只有一种产业 —— 威廉 · 莎士比亚；但这一产业有两个明显分开、且敌意日益加深的分支。一方是皇家莎士比亚剧团，在埃文河畔的莎士比亚纪念剧院演出精湛的戏剧；另一方是镇上居民，他们主要依靠游客生活。这些游客来此不是看戏，而是看安妮 · 海瑟薇故居、莎士比亚出生地及其他景点。

第 2 段

The worthy residents of Stratford doubt that the theater adds a penny to their revenue. They frankly dislike the RSC's actors, them with their long hair and beards and sandals and noisiness. It's all deliciously ironic when you consider that Shakespeare, who earns their living, was himself an actor (with a beard) and did his share of noise-making.

直译：斯特拉特福那些自认为体面的居民，怀疑剧院是否给他们的收入增加过一分钱。他们坦率地不喜欢皇家剧团的演员，不喜欢那些长头发、留胡须、穿凉鞋、吵吵闹闹的人。想到给他们带来生计的莎士比亚本人就是一个演员，留着胡须，也没少闹出动静，这一切就显得格外有趣而讽刺。

第 3 段

The tourist streams are not entirely separate. The sightseers who come by bus and often take in Warwick Castle and Blenheim Palace on the side don't usually see the plays, and some of them are even surprised to find a theatre in Stratford. However, the playgoers do manage a little sight-seeing along with their playgoing. It is the playgoers, the RSC contends, who bring in much of the town's revenue because they spend the night (some of them four or five nights) pouring cash into the hotels and restaurants. The sightseers can take in everything and get out of town by nightfall.

直译：两股游客并不完全分开。乘巴士来、常顺便参观沃里克城堡和布伦海姆宫的观光者，通常不看戏，其中有些人甚至惊讶于斯特拉特福竟有剧院。然而，来看戏的人在看戏之外，倒也会安排少量观光。皇家剧团主张，给小镇带来大量收入的正是看戏者，因为他们会过夜，有些住四五晚，把钱花在旅馆和餐馆。而观光者可以看完一切，在天黑前离开镇子。

第 4 段

The townsfolk don't see it this way and the local council does not contribute directly to the subsidy of the Royal Shakespeare Company. Stratford cries poor traditionally. Nevertheless every hotel in town seems to be adding a new wing or cocktail lounge. Hilton is building its own hotel there, which you may be sure will be decorated with Hamlet Hamburger Bars, the Lear Lounge, the Banquo Banqueting Room, and so forth, and will be very expensive.

直译：镇民不这样看，地方议会也不直接给皇家莎士比亚剧团提供补贴。斯特拉特福一向哭穷。然而，镇上每家旅馆似乎都在加建侧楼或鸡尾酒休息厅。希尔顿也正在那里建自己的旅馆；你尽可以确信，它会装饰上 " 哈姆雷特汉堡吧 "" 李尔休息厅 "" 班柯宴会厅 " 等等，而且价格昂贵。

第 5 段

Anyway, the townsfolk can't understand why the Royal Shakespeare Company needs a subsidy. (The theatre has broken attendance records for three years in a row. Last year its 1,431 seats were 94 per cent occupied all year long and this year they'll do better.) The reason, of course, is that costs have rocketed and ticket prices have stayed low.

直译：无论如何，镇民不理解皇家莎士比亚剧团为什么需要补贴。（剧院已连续三年打破观众上座纪录。去年，1431 个座位的全年上座率为 94%，今年还会更好。）原因当然是，成本已经飞涨，而票价一直保持较低水平。

第 6 段

It would be a shame to raise prices too much because it would drive away the young people who are Stratford's most attractive clientele. They come entirely for the plays, not the sights. They all seem to look alike (though they come from all over): lean, pointed, dedicated faces, wearing jeans and sandals, eating their buns and bedding down for the night on the flagstones outside the theatre to buy the 20 seats and 80 standing-room tickets held for the sleepers and sold to them when the box office opens at 10:30 a.m.

直译：如果大幅提高票价，就很可惜，因为那会赶走年轻人，而他们正是斯特拉特福最有吸引力的一群顾客。他们完全是为戏剧而来，不是为景点而来。他们看起来似乎都很相像，虽然来自各地：瘦削、棱角分明、专注的面孔，穿着牛仔裤和凉鞋，吃着小面包，夜里睡在剧院外的石板地上，为的是购买专门给这些露宿排队者预留的 20 张坐席票和 80 张站票；售票处上午 10 点半开门时，票就卖给他们。

篇章简析

主旨：莎士比亚故乡的商业旅游与戏剧艺术之间存在利益矛盾，作者对不愿补贴剧团的镇民抱有讽刺态度。第 3 段是强调句 It is the playgoers ... who ...；末段年轻观众的细节支持维持低票价的价值。

Text 3

第 1 段

When prehistoric man arrived in new parts of the world, something strange happened to the large animals: they suddenly became extinct. Smaller species survived. The large, slow-growing animals were easy game, and were quickly hunted to extinction. Now something similar could be happening in the oceans.

直译：史前人类到达世界上的新地区时，大型动物身上发生了奇怪的事：它们突然灭绝了。较小的物种存活下来。那些体型大、生长缓慢的动物是容易捕获的猎物，很快就被猎杀殆尽。如今，类似的事情可能正在海洋中发生。

第 2 段

That the seas are being overfished has been known for years. What researchers such as Ransom Myers and Boris Worm have shown is just how fast things are changing. They have looked at half a century of data from fisheries around the world. Their methods do not attempt to estimate the actual biomass (the amount of living biological matter) of fish species in particular parts of the ocean, but rather changes in that biomass over time. According to their latest paper published in Nature, the biomass of large predators (animals that kill and eat other animals) in a new fishery is reduced on average by 80% within 15 years of the start of exploitation. In some long-fished areas, it has halved again since then.

直译：人们多年来就知道海洋正遭过度捕捞。兰塞姆·迈尔斯和鲍里斯·沃尔姆等研究者所揭示的，是变化究竟有多快。他们考察了世界各地渔场半个世纪的数据。他们的方法并不试图估计海洋某些特定区域鱼类实际的生物量，即活体生物物质的总量，而是估计这种生物量随时间的变化。按照他们最新发表在《自然》的论文，一个新渔场中的大型捕食动物，即捕杀并吃掉其他动物的动物，其生物量在开发开始后的十五年内平均减少 80%。在一些长期捕捞的地区，此后又减少了一半。

第 3 段

Dr. Worm acknowledges that these figures are conservative. One reason for this is that fishing technology has improved. Today's vessels can find their prey using satellites and sonar, which were not available 50 years ago. That means a higher proportion of what is in the sea is being caught, so the real difference between present and past is likely to be worse than the one recorded by changes in catch sizes. In the early days, too, longlines would have been more saturated with fish. Some individuals would therefore not have been caught, since no baited hooks would have been available to trap them, leading to an underestimate of fish stocks in the past. Furthermore, in the early days of longline fishing, a lot of fish were lost to sharks after they had been hooked. That is no longer a problem, because there are fewer sharks around now.

直译：沃尔姆博士承认，这些数字是保守的。一个原因是捕鱼技术已改进。如今的船只能够利用卫星和声呐寻找猎物，这些技术五十年前还不能使用。这意味着，海中现有生物被捕获的比例更高，因此今昔真实差距很可能比捕获量变化所记录的差距更大。早期，延绳钓上的鱼也会更接近饱和，因此有些个体不会被捕到，因为已经没有带饵鱼钩可供捕捉它们，这就导致过去鱼类资源量被低估。此外，在延绳钓早期，许多鱼在上钩后被鲨鱼吃掉而损失。现在这不再是问题，因为附近的鲨鱼少了。

第 4 段

Dr. Myers and Dr. Worm argue that their work gives a correct baseline, which future management efforts must take into account. They believe the data support an idea current among marine biologists, that of the "shifting baseline". The notion is that people have failed to detect the massive changes which have happened in the ocean because they have been looking back only a relatively short time into the past. That matters because theory suggests that the maximum sustainable yield that can be cropped from a fishery comes when the biomass of a target species is about 50% of its original levels. Most fisheries are well below that, which is a bad way to do business.

直译：迈尔斯和沃尔姆认为，他们的工作给出了正确的基准线，未来的管理工作必须将其考虑在内。他们相信，这些数据支持海洋生物学家中流行的“移动基准线”观点：人们未能察觉海洋中发生的巨大变化，是因为他们只回顾相对短的一段过去。这很重要，因为理论表明，当目标物种的生物量约为其原始水平的 50% 时，渔场可以取得最大可持续捕获量。大多数渔场的生物量远低于这一水平，这不是一种好的经营方式。

篇章简析

主旨：大型海洋捕食者衰退严重，短期参照会低估历史损失。第 3 段解释捕获数据为何低估旧有资源：技术进步、鱼钩饱和、鲨鱼截食。第 2 段 That 引导主语从句；末段 50% 指生物量相对原始水平，而非每年捕捞一半。

Text 4

第 1 段

Many things make people think artists are weird. But the weirdest may be this: artists' only job is to explore emotions, and yet they choose to focus on the ones that feel bad.

直译：许多事情使人们觉得艺术家古怪。但最古怪的也许是这一点：艺术家唯一的工作是探索情绪，而他们偏偏选择关注那些令人感觉糟糕的情绪。

第 2 段

This wasn't always so. The earliest forms of art, like painting and music, are those best suited for expressing joy. But somewhere from the 19th century onward, more artists began seeing happiness as meaningless, phony or, worst of all, boring, as we went from Wordsworth's daffodils to Baudelaire's flowers of evil.

直译：情况并非一直如此。绘画和音乐等最早的艺术形式，最适合表达欢乐。但从 19 世纪起的某个时候，越来越多艺术家开始把幸福看作无意义、虚假，或最糟糕的 —— 无聊。我们从华兹华斯的水仙，走到了波德莱尔的《恶之花》。

第 3 段

You could argue that art became more skeptical of happiness because modern times have seen so much misery. But it's not as if earlier times didn't know perpetual war, disaster and the massacre of innocents. The reason, in fact, may be just the opposite: there is too much damn happiness in the world today.

直译：你可以说，艺术之所以更加怀疑幸福，是因为现代经历了太多苦难。但并不是说，更早的时代就不知道无休止的战争、灾难和对无辜者的屠杀。事实上，原因可能恰恰相反：今天世界上的幸福实在多得过头了。

第 4 段

After all, what is the one modern form of expression almost completely dedicated to depicting happiness? Advertising. The rise of anti-happy art almost exactly tracks the emergence of mass media, and with it, a commercial culture in which happiness is not just an ideal but an ideology.

直译：毕竟，哪一种现代表达形式几乎完全致力于描绘幸福？广告。“反幸福”艺术的兴起，几乎与大众传媒的出现同步；伴随大众传媒而来的商业文化中，幸福不仅是一种理想，也是一种意识形态。

第 5 段

People in earlier eras were surrounded by reminders of misery. They worked until exhausted, lived with few protections and died young. In the West, before mass communication and literacy, the most powerful mass medium was the church, which reminded worshippers that their souls were in danger and that they would someday be meat for worms. Given all this, they did not exactly need their art to be a bummer too.

直译：较早时代的人们身边，到处都是提醒他们苦难的事物。他们劳作到筋疲力尽，生活少有保障，年纪轻轻就死去。在西方，大众传播和识字普及以前，最强大的大众媒介是教会；它提醒信徒，他们的灵魂处于危险之中，而且有朝一日他们会成为虫子的食物。在这种情况下，他们实在不需要艺术也来使自己沮丧。

第 6 段

Today the messages the average Westerner is surrounded with are not religious but commercial, and forever happy. Fast-food eaters, news anchors, text messengers, all smiling, smiling, smiling. Our magazines feature beaming celebrities and happy families in perfect homes. And since these messages have an agenda—to lure us to open our wallets—they make the very idea of happiness seem unreliable. "Celebrate!" commanded the ads for the arthritis drug Celebrex, before we found out it could increase the risk of heart attacks.

直译：今天，普通西方人周围的信息不再是宗教性的，而是商业性的，并且永远快乐。吃快餐的人、新闻主播、发短信的人，个个都在微笑、微笑、微笑。杂志展示笑容灿烂的名人和住在完美住宅中的幸福家庭。由于这些信息带有一个目的 —— 诱使我们掏钱 —— 它们反而使幸福这个观念本身显得不可信。关节炎药物西乐葆的广告曾命令人们 " 庆祝吧！" 而后来我们才发现，它可能增加心脏病发作风险。

第 7 段

But what we forget—what our economy depends on us forgetting—is that happiness is more than pleasure without pain. The things that bring the greatest joy carry the greatest potential for loss and disappointment. Today, surrounded by promises of easy happiness, we need art to tell us, as religion once did, Memento mori: remember that you will die, that everything ends, and that happiness comes not in denying this but in living with it. It's a message even more bitter than a clove cigarette, yet, somehow, a breath of fresh air.

直译：但我们忘记了 —— 我们的经济也依赖我们忘记 —— 幸福不只是没有痛苦的快乐。带来最大喜悦的事物，也包含失落和失望的最大可能性。如今，周围充满轻易获得幸福的承诺，我们需要艺术像宗教曾经那样告诉我们：记住你会死，记住一切都会结束；幸福来自与这一事实共处，而不是否认它。这是一条比丁香香烟还苦涩的信息，却不知何故，也像一口清新空气。

篇章简析

主旨：商业文化不断兜售无痛的快乐，艺术因此有必要提醒人们面对有限、失落和死亡。第 3 段先提出常见解释再反驳；末段给出作者正面主张。not in denying this but in living with it 强调接受现实，而非追求痛苦本身。

整理说明：依据所附年度试卷提取 Text 1–Text 4；每段英文后接中文直译。已修复明显断词、粘连、错字和标点损坏。文中数据、事件及观点均置于原文章的历史语境中理解。篇章简析为本次整理所加。